

The blog

Personal voice, invite interaction

Word count ~250 or ~400 words	Register Informal to semi-formal	Title Post only (not a comment)	Key feature Personal, invite comments
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STRUCTURE AND LAYOUT

Username

Date / time

Title – post only – attention-grabbing

Introduction – ~50 words – hook the reader, introduce topic

Body paragraphs 1–3 – ~50–80 words each – one content point per paragraph

Conclusion – ~50 words – wrap up + invite readers to comment

DO'S AND DON'TS

DO

- Write in a personal, engaging voice
- Share personal experiences and opinions freely
- Address the reader directly ("you")
- Encourage readers to comment (blog post)
- Reference the original post in your opening (blog comment)
- Contractions are OK (don't, I'm, it's)
- Be original and show personality
- Shorter paragraphs work well here

DON'T

- Don't write like a report (too formal)
- Don't forget to invite comments (blog post)
- Don't forget to reference the original post (blog comment)
- Don't be rude or offensive – remember it's public
- Don't use academic phrases like "It is widely believed that..."

WEAKER VS. STRONGER

WEAKER

One should carefully consider the various advantages before deciding to take a gap year.

STRONGER

I used to think a gap year was just an expensive way to put off real life. Then I took one, and it changed my mind.

Why it matters. A blog needs a personal, informal voice, with contractions and a short story. A formal phrase like "one should consider" belongs in a different text type.

KEY TIP

For a blog comment, your very first sentence should refer to the original post, ideally by name: "Hi Jeff, I stumbled across your blog on overtourism and it really made me think..."

MODEL TEXT

Why I Quit Instagram for a Month (And What Happened Next) (~250 words · Informal register)

Structure Text-specific Language

by max_adventures · 22 March 2026, 19:34¹

Why I Quit Instagram for a Month (And What Happened Next)

OK so hear me out –² I know everyone talks about digital detoxes these days, but I actually went through with it. Last month I deleted Instagram from my phone. Cold turkey. No "screen time limits", no "I'll just check once a day" – gone. And honestly? It was weird.³ My friends genuinely thought I had lost my mind. One of them actually asked if I was okay, as if deleting an app were some kind of cry for help.

The first few days were rough. I kept unlocking my phone and staring at the empty space where the app used to be. I realised I'd been scrolling for about two hours every single day. That's basically⁴ the same as watching a movie. Every. Day.⁵ But after about a week, something clicked. I started reading before bed again. By the end of the second week, I had finished an entire book, the first one in months, and somehow my brain felt quieter and less twitchy⁶.

So, am I back on Instagram now? Yeah, I am. But I use it differently: maybe 20 minutes a day, max. The month off taught me it's just a tool, and I'd been treating it like a lifestyle. Have any of you tried something like this? I'd love to hear your stories in the comments!⁷ If you have ever felt like your phone owns you instead of the other way round, maybe give it a try. Worst case, you waste a weekend. Best case, you get a little piece of your life back.

WHAT THE EXAMINER NOTICES IN THIS MODEL

The numbers match the marked passages in the model text.

1. **Username + date/time – required for blog:** "by max_adventures · 22 March 2026, 19:34"
2. **Informal, personal tone – contractions OK:** "OK so hear me out –"
3. **Short sentence for effect – works in blogs:** "And honestly? It was weird."
4. **Informal register – fine for blogs:** "basically"
5. **Stylistic fragmentation – very blog-appropriate:** "Every. Day."
6. **Vivid personal detail:** "my brain felt quieter and less twitchy"
7. **Call to comment – required in blog posts:** "Have any of you tried something like this? I'd love to hear your stories in the comments!"

USEFUL PHRASES

Blog post openers

- It took me ages to figure this out, but...
- So, here's what I've been thinking about...
- You won't believe what happened to me...
- OK so hear me out –

Blog comment openers

- Hi [name], I've just seen your blog on...
- I stumbled across your post and...
- This really resonated with me because...

Engaging the reader

- What do you think?
- I'd love to hear your thoughts on this.
- Let me know in the comments!
- Has anyone else experienced this?
- Am I the only one who...?

More online. On the website this text type also has a second model text ("What three months without takeaway taught me", ~250 words · informal) and a realistic borderline text with notes on where it loses marks: matura.bernhardgmeiner.com/blog/